



ENG501

Treasure for Final-Term

ABSTRACT

This comprehensive collection of notes is accurately crafted to empower students to excel academically, ensuring they achieve a minimum of 80% marks in their examinations. The content is organized with clarity and precision, focusing on key concepts, critical analyses, and practical applications tailored to the syllabus. These notes serve as a reliable resource for both thorough preparation and last-minute revision. Designed to inspire confidence and mastery, this guide is an essential tool for students striving for academic excellence.

Maha Malik

History of English Language

Lesson 21

HISTORY OF ENGLISH FROM 1500 TO 1650 -PART 1

Topic – 101: Middle to Modern English 1500-1650

All Middle English long vowels underwent extensive alteration during this period. However, short vowels, in accented syllables, remained comparatively stable. If we compare Chaucer's pronunciation of the short vowels with ours, we note only two changes of importance: those of 'a' and 'u'. In some cases, this ME a represented in OE as æ (at, apple, back), and the new pronunciation was therefore a return to approximately the form that the word had had in Old English. It is the usual pronunciation in America and a considerable part of southern England today. The change that u underwent was what is known as unrounding. In Chaucer's pronunciation this vowel was like the u in full. By the sixteenth century, it seems to have become, in most words, the sound we have in but (e.g., cut, sun; love, with the Anglo-Norman spelling of o for u). So far as the short vowels are concerned, it is clear that a person today would have little difficulty in understanding the English of any period of the language.

Topic – 102: The Great Vowel Shift

The situation is very different when we consider the long vowels. In Chaucer's pronunciation, these had still their so-called 'continental' value—that is, a was pronounced like the a in father and not as in name. Also in Chaucer's pronunciation e was either like the e in there or the a in mate, but not like the ee in meet. But in 15th century, a great change happened i.e. all the long vowels gradually came to be pronounced with a greater elevation of the tongue and closing of the mouth. Most of the long vowels had approximately acquired their present pronunciation at least by the sixteenth century. The change occurred at the end of the seventeenth century and had become general by the middle of the eighteenth. The spelling of English had become fixed in a general way before the shift and therefore did not change when the quality of the long vowels changed. Consequently, our vowel symbols no longer correspond to the sounds they once represented in English and still represent in the other modern languages.

Topic – 105: Language Change: Renaissance

At the public level, a similar self-consciousness has driven issues of language policy over the past four centuries long before 'language policy' acquired its modern meaning. The beginnings of this public discussion are evident in the sixteenth-century defense of English – debates about orthography and the enrichment of the vocabulary. Anxiety about language policy and a new urgency in the second half of the 17th century could be felt. From the 18th century, proposals for an academy were presented. There was a growing self-consciousness about the shape of English language. With the growth of specialized knowledge, English language needed new vocabulary also because now Latin became less and less the vehicle for learned discourse. The rapid accumulation of new knowledge and less publishing of specialized and learned works in Latin also played a role. Selfconsciousness about language had two aspects: individual & public.

Lesson 22

HISTORY OF ENGLISH FROM 1500 TO 1650-PART 2

Topic – 106: Changing Vocabulary (1500-1650)

Historical event

- ❖ The Norman Conquest
- ❖ The Black Death
- ❖ More general - less influential

A radical force means anything that promotes change in language. Now these conditions are favorable to the spread of ideas and stimulating to the growth of the vocabulary. Apart from the special effects of the Norman Conquest, in the Middle Ages, changes in vocabulary were not so great.

Topic – 107: Changing Grammar (1500-1650)

The case of grammar was opposite to vocabulary. Changes in vocabulary were radical. On the other hand, treatment of grammar was conservative. The question is: what do we mean by conservative? It means something or somebody that tends to preserve the existing status. There was a relationship of various agencies in this regard:

- ❖ Printing press
- ❖ The reading habit
- ❖ The advances of learning
- ❖ Science
- ❖ Increased communication

The paradox of the situation was favorable to the spread of ideas and was stimulating to the growth of the vocabulary. But it created social consciousness to work actively toward the promotion and maintenance of a standard, especially in grammar and usage. So, changes in grammar have been relatively slight. But in the Middle English period changes in grammar were revolutionary.

Topic – 108: Problem of Orthography (1500-1650)

For the English, as for the French and the Italians, in the 16th century the question of orthography or 'right writing,' as Mulcaster preferred to call it, was important. Generally speaking, the spelling of the modern languages in the Middle Ages had attempted with fair success to represent the pronunciation of words. The same is true of English, though Norman scribes have introduced considerable confusion. How did they do so? The answer is:

- ❖ They tried to write a language that they knew imperfectly
- ❖ Followed pronunciation to create spelling
- ❖ Carried French habits

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The confusion was increased when certain spellings gradually became conventional while the pronunciation slowly changed. Reason was because the corresponding word in Latin was spelled so. For example, (debitum, dubitare).

Lesson 23

HISTORY OF ENGLISH FROM 1500 TO 1650-PART 3

Topic – 114: Reinforcement through French

It is not always possible to say whether a word is directly from Latin or came indirectly through French. Reason for this uncertainty is that a wholesale enrichment was going on simultaneously in French. The same words were being introduced in both languages. Often the two streams of influence merged. But of course, first hand borrowing happened. Word fact represents the Latin factum and not the French fait, which was taken into English earlier as feat. Verbs like confiscate, congratulate, and exonerate are formed from the Latin participle (confiscat-us, etc.) and not from the French confisquer, congratuler, exonerer. The form prejudicate is Latin while prejudice represents French prejurer. Instruct and subtract have Latin ancestry (instructus, subtractus). Why is it so? Well, the French instruire and soustraire would have become in English instroy (like destroy) and subtray (which is found in the fifteenth century). Conjugation is probably a direct importation from Latin (conjugation-em) since the more usual form in French was conjugaison.

Topic – 115: Permanent Additions and Adaptations

Sixteenth-century purists objected to three classes of strange words, which they characterized as:

1. Inkhorn terms
2. Oversea language
3. Chaucerisms

The foreign borrowings in this period were by no means confined to learned words taken from Latin and Greek. English vocabulary at this time was borrowing from more than fifty languages which included the following major languages:

- ❖ Latin
- ❖ Greek
- ❖ French
- ❖ Italian
- ❖ Spanish

Italian	French	Greek	Spanish/ Portuguese	Latin	Mexican	Cuba and West Indies	India
Algebra Balcony Design	Chocolate Comrade Detail	Biosphere Haemoglobin Microspecies	Alligator Apricot Banana	Allusion Democratic Imaginary	Chilli Chocolate Tomato	Barbecue Hammock Hurricane	Bangle Bungalow Cashmere

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Granite Piazza Portico Stanza Volcano	Duel Entrance Equip Essay Cartoon Patrol	Anonumous Criterion idosyncrasy	Corral Hammock Hurricane Maize Mosquito Potato	Juveline Sophisticated Aberration Enthusiasm	Burrito Chorizo	Maize Potato Tobacco	China Coolie Cot Curry Jungle Polo
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Reasons that promoted it all included:

- ❖ Cosmopolitan tendency
- ❖ Spirit of exploration and adventure
- ❖ Interest in the New World

Lesson 25

OVERVIEW OF THE DEVELOPMENT OF RENAISSANCE ENGLISH

Topic – 121: Renaissance: General Characteristics

The larger spirit of the age is reflected in linguistic matters. A conscious interest in the English language was taken. An attention to its problems is now widely manifested. The fifteenth century had witnessed sporadic attempts by individual writers to embellish their style with ‘aureate terms.’ These attempts show a desire to improve the language, at least along certain limited lines. But in the 16th Century:

- ❖ Books and pamphlets, prefaces and incidental observations were published to support linguistic change in English.
- ❖ Language was defended against those who were disposed to compare it unfavorably to Latin or other tongues.
- ❖ English recognized its position as the national speech and urged its fitness for learned and literary use.

Overall, this a time that showed a great desire to:

- ❖ fix language
- ❖ make it stable
- ❖ modernize it
- ❖ standardize it

Topic – 123: Standard Literary Language

This is a period of time when standard and recognizably ‘modern’ English developed. As an effect of the ‘Great Vowel Shift,’ the pronunciation was brought within measurable distance of that which prevails today. The influence of the printing press and the efforts of spelling reformers had resulted in a form of written English that offers little difficulty to the modern reader. New vocabulary was introduced but as far as grammar is concerned, it was fixed by this time. In the writings of Spenser, Shakespeare, and their contemporaries, a standard literary language is used free from the variations of local dialect. Although Sir Walter Raleigh might speak with a broad

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Devonshire pronunciation, Spenser and Shakespeare may have traces in their speech of their Lancashire and Warwickshire ancestry. They wrote common English without dialectal idiosyncrasies. So, Puttenham (1589) reminds us: ‘herein we are already ruled by the English Dictionaries and other bookes written by learned men, and therefore it needeth none other direction in that behalfe.’ Some characteristics of the language were not yet completely settled, but the written language in the latter part of the sixteenth century is fully entitled to be called Standard English. The regularization of spellings in this written standard can be seen as early as the mid-fifteenth century in the official documents of Chancery.

Topic – 125: What is Left Unsettled?

OE Words	Modern English
Whan	When
Shources	Showers
Droghte	Drought
Hath	Has
Roote	Root
Veyne	Vein
Swich	Such
Sonne	Sun
Smale	Small
Nyght	Night
Sartin	Certain
Consarn	Concern
Divert	Divert
Clark	Clerk
Smert	Smart

Lesson 26

HISTORY OF ENGLISH FROM 1650 TO 1800-PART 1

Topic – 126: Impact of 17th Century

There were new scientists and philosophers vs. religious zeal and occult science accompanied by belief in astrology, alchemy, and witchcraft. Radical Non-conformists and perceived fanatics were lumped together under the label ‘Enthusiasts’ by writers and scientists connected with the Royal Society, and conservative Anglicans. Supporters of rational science, such as Henry More, Thomas Sprat, John Wilkins, and Robert Boyle were disturbed by the ‘ranting’ language of the Enthusiasts. More conservative minds were concerned about the very fact of public expression and the sheer bulk of controversial publications. Learned discourse was no longer confined to elite circles. Also practitioners of Natural Science condemned the Enthusiasts and the old authorities. In fact, it was an open controversy and it was still very difficult for people to conceive that open controversy was either safe or beneficial to society.

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Treasure for Final-Term**

Topic – 129: The Problem of Refining English Language

It was Dryden's opinion that 'from Chaucer the purity of the English tongue began'. He was not convinced about the downward course of language. For Swift, the golden age was that of the great Elizabethans. His views were that there are corruptions in our language, but very few of the best authors have wholly escaped these. Dr. Johnson also agreed with this opinion. In his Dictionary he says: 'I have studiously endeavoured to collect examples and authorities from the writers before the restoration, whose works I regard as the wells of English undefiled, as the pure sources of genuine diction

Lesson 27

HISTORY OF ENGLISH FROM 1650 TO 1800-PART 2

Topic – 131: In the Footsteps of Italy and France

The principal function of the Academy shall be to labor with all possible care and diligence to give definite rules to our language, and to render it pure, eloquent, and capable of treating the arts and sciences.' Three major aims were:

1. To cleanse the language of impurities, both in writing and spoken language
2. To establish a certain usage of words
3. To compile a dictionary, a grammar, a rhetoric, and a treatise on the art of poetry

The dictionary was the most important project. Work proceeded slowly, and it appeared in 1694. Thus, while England continued to lament the lack of an adequate dictionary; Italy and France both had apparently achieved this object through the agency of academies.

Topic – 132: An English Academy

No doubt the vital incentive to the establishment of an academy in England came from the example of France and Italy. The suggestion occurs early in the seventeenth century. Indeed, learned societies had been known in England from 1572. With the Restoration, discussion of an English Academy became much more frequent. In the very year that Charles II was restored to the throne, a volume was published with the title New Atlantis...Continued by R. H. Esquire (1660) in which, as a feature of his ideal commonwealth, the author pictured an academy 'to purifie our Native Language from Barbarism or Solecism, to the height of Eloquence, by regulating the terms and phrases thereof into constant use of the most significant words, proverbs, and phrases, and justly appropriating them either to the Lofty, mean, or Comic stile.' Shortly thereafter, the idea of an academy received support from several influential persons, notably from Dryden and John Evelyn.

Topic – 133: Swift's Proposal

By the beginning of the eighteenth century, grounds had been prepared and time was ripe for an authoritative plan for an academy. With the example of Richelieu and the French Academy, doubtless in his mind, Swift addressed a letter in 1712 to the earl of Oxford, Lord Treasurer of

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England. It was published under the title A Proposal for Correcting, Improving, and Ascertaining the English Tongue. After the usual formalities, he then launches an attack against the innovations he had objected to in his paper, the Tatler, two years before. The remedy he offered was that a free judicious choice should be made of such persons, as are generally allowed to be best qualified for such a work, without any regard to quality, party, or profession. ... 'These, to a certain number at least, should assemble at some appointed time and place, and fix on rules, by which they design to proceed. What methods they will take, is not for me to prescribe.' The work of this group, as he conceives it, is described in the following terms:

'The persons who are to undertake this work will have the example of the French before them to imitate, where these have proceeded right, and to avoid their mistakes.' He further added: '... Besides the grammar-part, wherein we are allowed to be very defective, they will observe many gross improprieties, which, however authorized by practice, and grown familiar, ought to be discarded. They will find many words that deserve to be utterly thrown out of our language, many more to be corrected, and perhaps not a few long since antiquated, which ought to be restored on account of their energy and sound.' The publication of Swift's Proposal marks the culmination of the movement for an English Academy. Swift's proposal was objected and opposed by several people, mainly on political grounds. John Oldmixon, published Reflections on Dr. Swift's Letter to the Earl of Oxford, about the English Tongue. It was a violent attack with political motives. He said 'I should rejoice with him, if a way could be found out to fix our Language forever, that like the Spanish cloak, it might always be in Fashion.' But such a thing is impossible. Swift's proposal was not followed up properly and no serious effort was made to accomplish the purpose.

Topic – 135: Johnson's Dictionary- A Milestone

The chief intent of it is to preserve the purity, and ascertain the meaning of our English idiom.' He sums it up:

- ❖ The pronunciation of the language may be fixed.
- ❖ Its attainment facilitated.
- ❖ Its purity preserved.
- ❖ Its use ascertained.
- ❖ Its duration lengthened.
- ❖ In 1756 Sheridan wrote, 'if our language should ever be fixed, he must be considered by all posterity as the founder, and his dictionary as the corner stone.'

Lesson 28

HISTORY OF ENGLISH FROM 1650 TO 1800 -PART 3

Topic – 137: Confusion and Issues Related to Division in Stages

The Aims of the Grammarians

1. codify the principles of the language and reduce it to rule
2. settle disputed points and decide cases of divided usage

Maha Malik's Compilation

3. point out common errors or what were supposed to be errors, and thus correct and improve the language

Lesson 29

HISTORY OF ENGLISH FROM 1650 TO 1800 -PART 4

Topic – 142: Expansion of the British Empire: Impact

Borrowings

Mexican words: chili, chocolate, tomato etc.

From Cuba and the West Indies: Barbecue, hammock, hurricane, maize, potato, tobacco etc.

From Brazil and Other South American regions: Poncho, Tapioca etc.

From India: Bangle, bungalow, cashmere, China, coolie, cot, curry, jungle, jute, loot, mandarin, nirvana, polo, punch, rajah, rupee, sepoy, thug, toddy, tom-tom, and verandah.

- ❖ Kangaroo is an interesting example of native words that have passed into universal use.

Topic – 143: Progressive Verb Forms

It is impossible to follow the subject matter here in extensive details so only significant ones can be pointed out. One characteristic development in English grammar in the eighteenth century is regarding progressive verb forms.

- ❖ Where French Says: je chante or German ich singe
- ❖ English may say: I sing, I do sing, or I am singing.

Do-forms are emphatic forms. But their most important uses are in negative and interrogative sentences (I don't sing, do you sing?).

To be forms and the present participle are generally called progressive forms. Their most common use is to indicate an action as being in progress at the time implied by the auxiliary. The wide extension of the use of progressive forms is one of the most important developments of the English verb in the modern period.

In Old English, such expressions as 'he woes lærende' (he was teaching) are occasionally found but usually in translations from Latin. In early Middle English, progressive forms are distinctly rare. Their number increases in the Middle English period and the credit of their development goes to the sixteenth century. The chief factor in their growth is the use of the participle as a noun governed by the preposition on (he burst out on laughing). This weakened to he burst out a-laughing and finally to he burst out laughing. In the same way he was on laughing became he was a-laughing and he was laughing. Today such forms are freely used in all tenses (is laughing, was laughing, will be laughing, etc.).

Topic – 144: Progressive Passive

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The extension of such forms to the passive (the house is being built) was a later development. It belongs to the very end of the eighteenth century. Old English had no progressive passive. Such an expression as the man is loved, feared, hated is progressive only in so far as the verbs loving, fearing, hating imply a continuous state. But no such force attaches to The man is killed, which does not mean the man is being killed, but indicates a completed act. The construction the man is on laughing was capable also of a passive significance under certain circumstances. Thus, the house is on building can suggest only that the house is in process of construction. This use is found from the fourteenth century on, and in its weakened form the construction is not unknown today. With some verbs the construction was impossible in a passive sense. Thus, the idea he is always being called could not be expressed by he is always calling. At the end of the eighteenth century, we find the first traces of our modern expression The house is being built. The combination of being with a past participle to form a participial phrase had been in use for some time. Shakespeare says: which, being kept close, might move more grief to hide (Hamlet). This is thought to have suggested the new verb phrase. The earliest instance of the construction that has been noted is from the year 1769. However, it is generally used only in the present and simple past tense (is or was being built). We can hardly say the house has been being built for two years, and we avoid saying it will be being built next spring.

Lesson 30

INTRODUCTION TO MODERN ENGLISH

Topic – 149: The World Wars and their Impact on English

We may observe some of the words that came into English between 1914 and 1918 as a direct consequence of World War I. Some of these were military terms representing new methods of warfare, such as air raid, antiaircraft gun, tank, and blimp. Gas mask and liaison officer were new combinations. Camouflage was borrowed from French. Where it had formerly been a term of the scene-painter's craft, but it caught the popular fancy.

Old Words, New Uses

- ❖ Sector (Old= a specific portion of the fighting line)
- ❖ Barrage (originally an artificial barrier like a dam in a river)

Lesson 31

STANDARDIZATION OF ENGLISH IN THE 19TH AND 20TH CENTURY

Topic – 152: Standardization of Spelling & Changes in Pronunciation

There are a few differences between Addison's punctuation and what would be considered correct today. For example, the use of capital letters and the apostrophe in the plural Opera's. So, the so-called greengrocer's apostrophe' in plurals such as potato's and tomato's is a recent innovation - consequence of declining educational standards. Addison can be taken as an example of good style in the 18th century. His spelling is almost identical with ours. There are minor differences like carry'd and publick, but essentially the system of orthography is the one we use now. In

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Middle English and Early Modern English, there had been no standard spelling. However, it is varied from writer to writer and even within the work of one writer. Even proper names were not fixed, for example Shakespeare, in the three signatures uses two different spellings (Shakspere and Shakspeare).

Other variants: Shagspere, Shackespere and Shakespeare. A powerful force for standardization is the introduction of printing. By the middle of the 16th century, there was still no standard system but quite a number of widely accepted conventions. By the end of the early modern period, the spelling had become standardized in printed books' though there is variation in people's private writings.

Pronunciation

One result of these inconsistencies is the prevalence of spelling pronunciations that have happened with universal education plus the wide dissemination of new words from books in printed form and this results in never heard/pronounced words in the home environment. Schedule began with /s-/, and was commonly spelt sedule or cedul; the spelling with sch dates from the mid-seventeenth century and has led to the present- pronunciations, /ʃ-/ and /sk-/.

Late Modern Period

Perhaps the most important change has been the disappearance of /r/ before consonants and before a pause. Formerly, the /r/ was always pronounced in words like barn and person and father. Today, in England, /r/ is never pronounced in words like barn and person but it is pronounced in words like father only if it occurs before a vowel ('father and mother').

Topic – 153: Slang in the 19th and 20th Centuries

Slang is a peculiar kind of vagabond language. We find it always hanging on the outskirts of legitimate speech but it is continually forcing its way into the most respectable community. It is a part of language and cannot be ignored. Nineteenth century is significant for the growth of a more objective and scientific attitude towards slang. The word slang does not occur in Johnson's Dictionary. In its early use, it always has a derogatory force. Webster in 1828 defines it as 'low, vulgar, unmeaning language.'

Topic – 154: Issues of Register and Accent

RP and Regional Accents A non-regional accent based on the speech of the great public schools has been accepted as a standard in England for well over a century. Increasingly, however, RP has lost some of its prestige as people educated at public schools have lost their monopoly of power and education. Today, the majority of university students are not speakers of RP. And it is from them that a large part of the English professional classes are recruited. Most school teachers, too, do not use RP but an educated regional accent, so that the influence of the schools is toward this rather than toward RP. RP now is the accent usually taught to foreigners learning British English. Rise in the prestige of all national and regional accents in Britain has taken place. Very respected broadcasters on the BBC now have educated Welsh and Scottish accents. Still, there is

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considerable prejudice against 'broad' regional accents but what are popularly known as 'soft' accents are now in many contexts more acceptable than the RP.

Lesson 32

19TH AND 20TH CENTURY ENGLISH: TENDENCIES

Topic – 157: Pidgins and Creoles

There are numerous pidgins and creoles in the world today. Their number is over two hundred. They are based on many different languages including Swahili, Arabic, Malay, and Japanese.

Definition

A pidgin is an auxiliary language used in the first place for the purposes of trade between groups that have no common language. It arises when two or more languages are in contact. It is a simplified form of the dominant one, with influence from the other(s). This restricted type can eventually be capable of fulfilling all language functions. It may even become an official language: Papua New

Guinea's pidgin, called Tok Pisin, is formally acknowledged in the country's constitution. Some pidgins die out because the need dies out; others spread and gain wide currency. Today, many English-based pidgins are in use, especially in the coastal regions of West Africa and on the islands of the Caribbean and the Pacific.

Creole

When a pidgin becomes the first language of a group=creole. There are English-based creoles in the Caribbean, for example, in Barbados and Jamaica. Even in the United States, the creole called Gullah is spoken by about a quarter of a million people living along the south-eastern coastal areas. Pidgins and creoles co-exist with standard varieties of the donor language. In Jamaica, for example, an English-based creole exists alongside Standard English. Approximately, there are more than nine million people speak pidgin and creole languages throughout the world and about thirty to forty percent are English based. The single word hum in English is expressed in Tok Pisin (literally 'talk pidgin') by the circumlocution, singsing long taim maus i pas ('to sing when the mouth is closed'). English 'grass' in Tok Pisin is gras; Moustache' is mausgras; Beard' is gras bilong fes ('grass on face'); Hair' is gras bilong hed; Eyebrow' is gras antap longai ('grass on top along eye'). In the same way 'my mother' is mama bilong mi; 'John's house' is haus bilong John. The distinction between pidgins and creoles is not a sharp one, for sometimes a variety is used by some groups as an auxiliary language and by others as a first language. This is particularly true in West Africa where the co-existence of more than four hundred different languages means that pidgins are especially useful. A pidgin tends to preserve the absolutely minimal grammatical structures needed for effective communication and reduces redundancy to almost nil. The great simplification of pidgin-creole structures as compared with the donor language is seen in both phonology and grammar. Number of phonemes is reduced in a creole, so in Jamaican Creole, many speakers use the same vowel in block as in black (both [blak]), the same vowel in beer as in bare (both [biə]).

Lesson 34

ENGLISH AS WORLD LANGUAGE

Topic – 168: English as a Mother Tongue

English as First Language English is spoken as first language in USA, Canada, Britain, Ireland, Australia, New Zealand, South Africa, several Caribbean countries, and a scattering of other territories. Today, English is the second or third most popular mother tongue in the world with an estimated 350-400 million native speakers. Best recent estimates of first languages suggest that Mandarin Chinese has around 800-850 million native speakers, while English and Spanish both have about 330-350 million each. Hindi speakers number 180-200 million, Bengali 170-180 million, Arabic 150-220 million, Portuguese 150-180 million, Russian 140-160 million and Japanese roughly 120 million. However, no language has ever been spoken by more than a dozen or so countries as a mother tongue. So, mother-tongue use by itself cannot give a language global status.

Then How?

It has to be taken up by other countries around the world.

Three-pronged Development

- ❖ Of first-language
- ❖ Second-language
- ❖ Foreign-language

Thus, it is inevitable that a language eventually comes to be used by more people than any other language. English has now reached this stage. Its first language speakers are above 400 million though estimates vary greatly because only a few countries keep statistics about numbers of speakers. Those who have learned it as a second language are also difficult to estimate, though approximately there are around 400 million such speakers. When the number of people who speak English as a foreign language is taken into account, again estimates are uncertain. No-one knows how many people are learning English in China. But the British Council has estimated that roughly a billion people are learning English around the world at any one time. Excluding complete beginners, it would seem reasonable to take two-thirds of these as a guess with whom it would be possible to hold a reasonable conversation in English – say 600 million. The grand total was about 1,400 million. In round terms = a quarter of the world's population (just over 6,000 million in 2000). No other language is used so extensively – either numerically or with such geographical reach. So, the current status of English is determined by its role other than as mother tongue.

Topic – 169: English as a Lingua Franca

Lingua Franca is a language that is adopted as a common language between speakers whose native languages are different. In the past = Arabic=Islamic world= from AD 733-AD 1792= spread from the borders of China and Northern India through Central Asia, Persia, Asia Minor, and Middle East to North Africa. The term lingua franca = first coined = beginning of the 17th century by the

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Italians. Conglomeration of mostly Italian, with a smattering of French, Portuguese, Spanish, Turkish, Greek, and Arabic was used primarily as the language of commerce. The term literally means 'Frankish language,' as 'Frank' was a common designation for all western Europeans since approximately the 12th century. Today an obvious factor= the need for a common language or lingua franca an old concept. But for whole world = emerged strongly only in the twentieth century, and since the 1950s in particular. The chief international forum for political communication – the United Nations – dates only from 1945, and then it had only fifty-one member states. By 1960, this had risen to over eighty members. The increase continued steadily into the 1990s. In 2003, there were 191 members in the UN – nearly four times as many as there were fifty years ago. The need for lingua francas is obvious, and pressure to find a single lingua franca is a consequence. The alternative = multi-way translation facilities= expensive= impracticable.

Where is it Used?

It is serving as a useful heuristic in Europe, where a Spaniard, a Frenchman, and a German might all carry on a conversation in English. English as a lingua franca (ELF) plays an important role in former Anglophone colonies such as India, Pakistan, Nigeria, Uganda, and Zimbabwe, among many others.

How is it used?

- ❖ ELF differs from Standard English in a number of ways.
- ❖ Several documented overarching similarities and variances.
- ❖ Variances in article usage (or no article usage at all)
- ❖ Variances in preposition usage
- ❖ Novel use of morphemes (such as importancy and smoothfully)

Criticism

While ELF is a widespread and useful mode of communication for many, some scholars and linguists have criticized its proliferation as a form of linguistic imperialism. Speakers of ELF may eventually speak both their native language and English imperfectly leading to issues with effective communication. In spite of these criticisms, ELF continues to flourish in many countries, oftentimes enriching the language with colorful aphorisms and unique phrases.

Topic – 170: Divergent Development in Modern English

Phonology

Different varieties of English can differ phonologically in three main ways. First, their phonological systems can differ: for example, the inventory of phonemes may be different. Secondly, the realizations of the same phoneme can be different, that is, be pronounced differently. Thirdly, the distribution of phonemes can differ; different phonemes may be selected for the pronunciation of a given word. Also, there can be differences of stress and intonation.

Phonology: Outer-circle Varieties of English

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Outer-circle varieties of English often differ considerably in phonological system from RP and General American. The number of phonemes is often much reduced. In many varieties of English in the outer circle, there is no difference between long and short vowels.

Example

In one common form of Nigerian English, for example, there is only one phoneme corresponding to RP /ɪ/ and /i:/, so that bid and bead are both /bɪd/; only one corresponding to /a/ and /ɑ:/, so that hat and heart are both /hæt/; only one corresponding to /ɒ/, /ʌ/ and /ɔ:/, so that stock, stuck and stork are all /stɒk/; and only one corresponding to RP /ʊ/ and /u:/, so that look and Luke are both /lʊk/.

Grammar

There are only minor grammatical differences between the main standard forms of English.

Vocabulary

It is perhaps in vocabulary that we see the greatest divergences between the different varieties of English as a first language. However, it is expanding across the vast North American continent with new flora and fauna and different natural features from those of Europe, building up a new society, building up new vocabulary.

Lesson 35

INTRODUCTION TO AMERICAN ENGLISH

Topic – 171: English in America & its Features

Objective

American English, sometimes called United States English or U.S. English, or AME, AE, AmEng, USEng, en-US is the set of varieties of the English language native to the United States. English is the most widely spoken language in the United States.

- ❖ The common language used by the federal government.
- ❖ Considered the de facto language of the country.

It has been given official status by 32 of the 50 state governments. The use of English in the United States is a result of British colonization of the Americas. The first wave of English-speaking settlers arrived in North America during the 17th century, followed by further migrations in the 18th and 19th centuries. Since then, American English has developed into new dialects, in some cases under the influence of West African and Native American languages, German, Dutch, Irish, Spanish, and other languages of immigrants. Any American or even Canadian English accent perceived as free of noticeably local, ethnic, or cultural markers is popularly called ‘General American English.’ Sociolinguist William Labov describes it as ‘a fairly uniform broadcast standard in the mass media.’

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Otherwise, however, historical and present linguistic evidence does not support the notion of there being a mainstream Standard English of the United States. According to Labov, with the major exception of Southern American English, regional accents throughout the country are not yielding to this broadcast standard. On the contrary, the sound of American English continues to evolve, with some local accents disappearing, but several larger regional accents emerging. Compared with English as spoken in England, North American English is more homogeneous. Also, it has remained relatively more conservative. North America has given the English lexicon many thousands of words, meanings, and phrases. Several thousand are now used in English as spoken internationally. The process of coining new lexical items started as soon as the colonists began borrowing names for unfamiliar flora, fauna, and topography from the Native American languages.

Topic – 172: American Dialects: Linguistic Variety and Uniformity in America

Cultural and Ethnic American Eng. Varieties

- ❖ African American Vernacular (Ebonics)
- ❖ Cajun Vernacular
- ❖ Hawain Pidgin
- ❖ Latino Vernacular Englishes

Cultural and Ethnic American Eng. Varieties

- ❖ Chicano English
- ❖ Miami English
- ❖ Pennsylvania Dutch English
- ❖ Yeshiva English

Regional and Local

- ❖ Eastern New England
- ❖ Boston
- ❖ Rhode island
- ❖ Southeast Super region
- ❖ Mid Atlantic

Topic – 175: American English Vocabulary

There never have been any major linguistic differences between British and American English as such. Moreover, the last hundred years or so have seen an increasing similarity between British and American English.

Reasons

- ❖ Partly due to ever-improving communication systems
- ❖ Partly due to the impact of American culture, notably through television and film

Lesson 36

AMERICAN VS BRITISH ENGLISH: A COMPARISON

Topic – 178: AmE (American English) & BrE (British English): Morphological Differences

This divergence between American English and British English has provided opportunities for humorous comment e.g., one of George Bernard Shaw's characters says that the United States and United Kingdom are 'two countries divided by a common language.' Morphology is the study of words, how they are formed, and their relationship to other words in the same language. It analyzes the structure of words and parts of words, such as stems, root words, prefixes, and suffixes. At the morphological level, difference in AmE and BrE exists.

Topic – 180: AmE & BrE (Syntactic Differences)

American style is more tolerant of lengthy noun string modifiers

- ❖ Department spokeswoman Darla Jordan;
- ❖ Death penalty opponent Helen Prejean;
- ❖ Celebrity capital punishment opponent Susan Sarandon

Lesson 37

AUSTRALIAN ENGLISH

Topic – 181: Australian English: Speakers and Demographics

Australia, Aussie, Oz Australia is a young nation: the Commonwealth of Australia was formed from a combination of states only in 1901, and the Australian Capital Territory was later established for a new capital, Canberra. During the First World War, Aussie (pronounced 'Ozzie') became an informal short form for both the noun Australian and the adjective (as in Aussie Rules for a code of football which originated in Australia). These days, there is also an informal name for Australia: OZ. For obvious reasons the joking expression Down Under, used to refer to Australasia, is interpreted by many Australians and New Zealanders as showing a snobbish 'northern hemisphere perspective.' Although English has been spoken in Australia for more than 200 years, Australian English began to be seriously recognized as a distinct variety of English only after the Second World War.

Topic – 182: Australia: The First Fleet

The discovery of gold in 1851 accelerated immigration, so after ten years later the Australian settler population had reached almost 1.2 million – a threefold increase in ten years. The gold rush also brought to an end the transportation of convicts since the gold seemed to provide an opportunity for reward, rather than punishment. From this time the pattern of immigration gradually changed in that Australia became increasingly populated by people of different nationalities. But the first largescale nonBritish/Irish immigration did not occur until after the Second World War.

Topic – 183: What becomes Australian English?

ENG501_History of English Language

Treasure for Final-Term

Australia is a young nation, but its aboriginal population has been living here for thousands of years. 'If the history of language in Australia, currently thought in the more conservative estimates to span about 40,000 years, is reduced in imagination to a period of 24 hours, the share of English, on the same scale, is about seven minutes.' Archaeological evidence suggests that the first Aborigines migrated from Southeast Asia to Australia. Among them, the indigenous people do not have a uniform name but accept the term borigines, derived from Latin aborigine meaning 'from the beginning.' The first Aboriginal loanword in English was appropriately kangaroo, today's national symbol of Australia. It was recorded by the naturalist Joseph Banks in 1770. Captain Cook, in his diary, has mentioned a strange hopping animal which, according to him was called by natives Kangooroo or Kanguru. In the language that the first expedition encountered, ganjurrus was the name for one particular species of kangaroo, not a generic name. Most Aboriginal loanwords refer to the Australian fauna and flora, such as the small yellow-green parrot budgerigar, the wild dog dingo, and the arboreal marsupial. If you are travelling in Australia, it is fascinating to read road signs that are a mixture of AngloSaxon names like Liverpool and Newcastle and Aboriginal names like Wagga Wagga and Indooroopilly. The white settlement in Australia was disastrous for both the indigenous population and their languages. Today, the Aborigines number less than 400,000, many of them speaking English only. Among the surviving Australian Aboriginal languages, about 50 are in active first-language use, mostly in places remote from major population centers. It is feared that it will not be long before most of these languages die out. In Australia, New Zealand, and South Africa, there is little regional variation in the language. BUT social and ethnic variations exist. Some speakers use a 'broader' accent, that is, one that is remoter from RP, and use more local Australian words in their vocabulary, but similar variations are found all over the country.

Topic – 184: Australian English Today

The characteristic sound of Australian speech is found especially in its vowels. Here are a few differences between 'broader' Australian English and standardized British pronunciation RP: In words such as say, in Australian English the diphthong is a wider sound pronounced close to /a/ where RP has /e/. In words such as now, where RP has /aʊ/, the diphthong approximates to /æʊ/ or even /ɛə/. RP-vowels /i:/ and /u:/ are often pronounced as diphthongs, so that see and do resemble /sə/ and /dəʊ/. Some vowels are pronounced with the tongue higher than in RP, so that ham sounds rather like /hɛm/, and pen sounds rather like /pæn/. In words like happy, the final -y is pronounced /i/ in RP but has a more salient pronunciation in Australian English – more like a long vowel: /hɛpi:/. The most common vowel in English, the unstressed schwa vowel /ə/, is more generally used than in RP. For example, chatted in RP is pronounced as /ætɪd/, whereas in Australian English, it is pronounced with a schwa. Overall, Australian English has uniformity in features.

Topic – 185: Features of Australian English

Compilation

International English Spelling Chart

 United States	 Canada	 United Kingdom	 Australia
color	colour	colour	colour
center	centre	centre	centre
realize	realize	realise/ize	realise
analyze	analyze	analyse	analyse
traveling	travelling	travelling	travelling
defense	defence	defence	defence
computer program, concert program	computer program, concert program	computer program, concert programme	computer program, concert program
gray	grey	grey	grey
fulfill	fulfil(l)	fulfil	fulfil
aging	ag(e)ing	ageing	ag(e)ing

Lesson 38

SOUTH-ASIAN ENGLISH

Topic – 186: Introduction to South-Asian English

The worldwide spread of English is an unprecedented phenomenon for which we do not find any example in human history. English was brought to the subcontinent in the early seventeenth century by British colonialism. Today, it is spoken as a second language by 3 percent of the population of Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, the Maldives, Nepal, Pakistan, and Sri Lanka. In numerical terms, we can safely say that there are approximately 33 million English speaking people. South Asian English is sometimes called 'Indian English' as British India included most of the region, but today, the varieties of English are usually divided according to the modern states. In India, there are 25 million users of English, even more than Australia. There are intra-national and intraregional role of 'link' language among people of diverse linguistic backgrounds. After so many years of independence, the countries of South Asia still use English to varying degrees in the domains of government administration, law, the military, higher education, commerce, the media, and the arts. In Pakistan, English has the status of an official language alongside the national language, Urdu. In Sri Lanka, there are efforts to 'peoplize' English. In Bangladesh, despite strong Bangla movement, English enjoys importance. In South Asian countries, it plays the role of the international medium for communication with the global community of nations.

Topic – 187: Features of South Asian English

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English was introduced to South Asia in the early 17th century and was reinforced by the long rule of the British Empire. Today, it is spoken as a second language by about 33 million people, 3% of the total population. Today, the varieties of South Asian English are divided according to the modern states:

- ❖ Bangladeshi English
- ❖ Indian English
- ❖ Nepali English
- ❖ Pakistani English
- ❖ Sri Lankan English

Although it is fairly homogeneous across the region, sharing 'linguistic features and tendencies at virtually all linguistic levels,' there are also differences based on various factors.

Indian English

It has words of Indian vernaculars that have made their way into the English language.

Examples include jungle, tank, bungalow, shampoo, verandah. It has political, sociological, and administrative terms of modern India: dharna, hartal, eve-teasing, votebank, swadeshi, tiffin, hillstation, gymkhana. We need to notice its resemblance with Pakistani English.

Vocabulary

- ❖ Our company lays great stress on technical training and knowledge 'upgradation'.
- ❖ The Prime Minister greeted the presspersons with a 'namaskar' and a broad smile.
- ❖ I read the newspaper 'matrimonials' on Sundays, especially the 'English-knowing' intelligentsia.

Spelling and Pronunciation

Most Indian languages, unlike English, have a nearly phonetic spelling, so the spelling of a word is a highly reliable guide to its pronunciation. The word 'of' is usually pronounced with a /f/ instead of a /v/ as in most other accents. Pronunciation of as [haus] is prevalent for both noun and verb instead of [haʊz] as noun and [haʊz] as verb.

Topic – 188: South Asian English: Imperialistic Legacy and Regional Asset

Languages of Imperialism in South Asia have a long history. In the second millennium, B.C.E. speakers of Old Indo-Aryan came into South Asia from the northwest in present day Afghanistan and spread southward and eastward, partly by peaceful settlement but largely by force of arms. In a few hundred years, the invaders had spread across the Indus Valley civilization (now Pakistan), reached modern Bihar and Bengal, and even migrated to Sri Lanka. The use of their language, in the form of Sanskrit, has persisted in South Asia to the present day. In the form of its descendants, the modern Indo-Aryan languages, Indo-Aryan is the mother tongue of a large proportion of the population of every country in South Asia. But, Sanskrit itself as a superposed language is the clearest linguistic legacy from this early imperialism in the area. Sanskrit is related to Hinduism in special ways. Persian, similarly, has been associated with Islam. The coming of Islam to South

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Asia is generally dated to 711 C.E., when an Arab naval force entered what is now Pakistan from the Arabian Sea and conquered the Indus valley. This incursion probably did not introduce the use of Persian, however, that came with the raids of Mahmud of Ghazni in the eleventh century. Although, at one point, Mahmud officially reintroduced Arabic as the language of the laws and administration, it was Persian, the second great Islamic language that was the principal language of his empire, centered in Lahore. Persian continued to be the chief court language of successive Muslim kingdoms, sultanates, and empires down to the Moghul Empire, centered in Delhi which yielded to the power of Great Britain. In all these polities, Persian was a major and often the dominant language. Limited uses of Persian have persisted in South Asia until the present time.

Topic – 189: Syntax of South Asian English

In recent years, there has been a growing recognition of institutionalized nonnative varieties of English (such as South Asian English). Existing descriptions of IVEs cover only small areas of lexical, morphological, and phonological structure with even less attention paid to syntax. Although these sentences are not necessarily ungrammatical in other varieties of English, they would probably be considered unidiomatic.

Examples

- ❖ Since her birth, she has been under the hands of men (subservient to).
- ❖ Women in this century have come very forward.

See and Look

- ❖ If we see only in the direction of art and literature
- ❖ Now, look the difference between

House for Home

Women came out of the house for studying.

Legs for Feet

She can stand on her own legs and face the society.

Lesson 39

ENGLISH LANGUAGE IN 21ST CENTURY: FEATURES OF ENGLISHES

Topic – 191: The Recency of World English & the Future of English

English as a first language is used in the USA, Canada, Britain, Ireland, Australia, New Zealand, South Africa, and a scattering of other territories. It is the official language which means it is the primary medium of communication in such domains as government, the law courts, broadcasting, the press, and the educational system. English now has some kind of special administrative status in over seventy countries, such as Ghana, Nigeria, Zimbabwe, India, Singapore, and Vanuatu. English achieves a special role when it is made a priority in a country's foreign-language teaching

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policy; it has no official status, but it is nonetheless the foreign language which children are most likely to encounter when they arrive at school.

Topic – 194: The Expanding Circle of English

English is spoken in Circles:

The Indian-American scholar Braj Kachru has mentioned three concentric circles of English. The Inner Circle= First language.

The Inner Circle

The inner circle includes the United States, Canada, and the West Indies in the New World; Britain and Ireland in Europe; and Australia, New Zealand, and South Africa in the Southern Hemisphere. In these eight regions, over 320 million people use English as a first language. They enjoy a privilege since they learn, for free, to speak this global language with a native accent.

The Outer Circle

The outer circle refers to a circle where English is a second, often official or semi-official language but where most users of the language are not native speakers. In the Outer Circle, we mostly find people who live in former British colonies, such as Kenya and Tanzania in Africa, and India, Pakistan, Malaysia, and Singapore in Asia.

The Expanding Circle

The circle where English is learned and used as a foreign language is known as the expanding circle. It encompasses large parts of the world where English is learned as a foreign language because it is found useful, or indeed indispensable, for international contacts. This circle now seems to be everexpanding, strengthening the claims of English as the international language of today. In the not too distant future, it will be appropriate to rename the 'Expanding Circle' as the 'Expanded Circle.'

Lesson 40

FUTURE OF ENGLISH

Topic – 196: Social and Political Power Associated with English

Pronunciation and Grammar

Its pronunciation is not simpler than that of many other languages; its grammar is no simpler.

Spelling

Its spelling certainly is not simpler than other languages. A language becomes a world language for a reason only – the power of the people who speak it. But power means different things: it can mean political power, cultural power, technological power, and economic power. Each of these influenced the growth of English at different times.

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Political Power

It emerged in the form of the colonialism that brought English around the world from the sixteenth century so that by the nineteenth century, the language was one 'on which the sun never sets.'

Cultural Power

In the twentieth century, we indeed saw the cultural power manifesting itself in virtually every walk of life through spheres of chiefly American influence. As a result of these different manifestations of cultural power, it is possible to recognize ten domains in which English has become pre-eminent.

Topic – 197: Power of Knowledge and English Today

English is the medium of a great deal of the world's knowledge, especially in such areas as science and technology and access to knowledge is the business of education. When we investigate why so many nations have in recent years made English an official language or chosen it as their chief foreign language in schools, one of the most important reasons is always educational. Since the 1960s, English has become the normal medium of instruction in higher education in many countries – including several where the language has no official status. Advanced courses in the Netherlands, for example, are widely taught in English. No African country uses its indigenous language in higher education; English is being used in the majority of cases. The English language teaching (ELT) business has become one of the major growth industries around the world in the past half century.

The Role of the Internet

The public acquisition of the Internet is another element contributing to the revolutionary linguistic character of the 1990s and the one where the epithet 'revolutionary' is easiest to justify. Although the Internet as a technology had been around since the 1960s, for e-mails and chat, very few people began exploiting it until thirty years later. The World Wide Web itself came into existence only in 1991. But in an extraordinarily short time, people adopted and mastered the technology and in the course of doing that encountered, adapted, and expanded its highly distinctive language. Now think of slang and jargon, breaking the conventional linguistic rules of spelling and punctuation, and other such practices. It is thought that three-quarters of the world's mail is in English; but as no one monitors the language in which we write our letters, such statistics are highly speculative. Only on the internet, where messages and data can be left for indefinite periods of time, is it possible to develop an idea of how much of the world's everyday communications is actually in English. In this regard, we also need to think of inventions, machines, and discoveries.

Topic – 198: Language Themes for 21st Century

Because there was so much linguistic innovation and change in the 1990s, several of our assumptions about language which we took for granted in the twentieth century need to be revised for the twenty-first. The arrival of a global language, English, has altered the balance of linguistic power in unprecedented ways, and has generated a whole new set of attitudes about language and languages. Many speech communities have begun to feel threatened by a situation which can alter

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the character of their language, or, in the worst case, can cause the use of their language to become so reduced that its very survival is at risk. Several are finding it necessary to introduce protective policies or at least to find ways of managing the effects of the linguistic changes they are experiencing. At an international level, such as in the European Union, more sophisticated strategies are to be implemented to safeguard the principle of language equivalence while recognizing the practical fact that virtually everyone speaks English. At the same time, communities want to exploit the opportunities for empowerment opened up by the availability of an international lingua franca. They find themselves having to take fresh measures, such as devoting resources to English language teaching. Also introducing an English-language dimension at senior levels of management can be noticed. Tourist potential is maintained by incorporating an English interpreting facility into important venues.

Issue

Learners and teachers have to get to grips with a rapidly diversifying language in which evolving regional standards and an increasing number of 'New Englishes' complicate a world where once only British and American English ruled. Moreover, the process of change has been radically affected by the arrival of the Internet. The netspeak community is unprecedented in its size today. So, here we need to consider the possible language themes for the 21st Century. There is a need for fresh policies and strategies. Teachers find that they must give their students exposure to new varieties and forms of English. There are concerns regarding examination system. There is also a need for a respectful attention to regional accents and dialects, both nationally and internationally. Legal status and system of documents or the copyright position of creative work is another aspect of concern. There is an unprecedented linguistic crisis in its scale and urgency, and in the twenty-first century, there is a huge responsibility on governments, international organizations, philanthropists, artists, and activists.

Topic – 199: Future of English

English Tomorrow

It is dangerous to extrapolate or to prophesy about the linguistic scenario of tomorrow's world. None of us can guess; what the English language will be like in a hundred years' time? The changes of recent decades suggest what forces are at work in the language today and the likely shape of things in the next few decades. But the history of the language in the coming century will depend on the history of the community. One of the striking things at the moment is the expansion going on in the vocabulary. If this continues, the change over a century will be comparable to that of such earlier periods as 1300 to 1400 or 1550 to 1650. Another trend is dialect-mixing. Unless some global disaster disrupts world communications, this is likely to continue. In England, other educated regional varieties of the language have achieved parity of esteem. Now it is normal for TV services in the English regions to have announcers and presenters who use the local form of the language. In pronunciation, such trends as the diphthongization of the long close vowels may well continue and could lead to further changes in the vowel system. In grammar, the trends of the past thousand years continue in small ways. More substantial changes could be caused by the permeation of the standard language by usages which at present are informal and/or non-standard.

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In grammar, for example, past-tense forms like 'I done' might become acceptable, as might the conflation of adjective and adverb forms. Perhaps more controversially, the reduced forms used in electronic communications such as text messaging and e-mail, like L8 for 'late' and LOL for 'laugh out loud,' might find their way into other kinds of written usage. What we can be sure of is that the process of change, which we have traced from the early IndoEuropean records up to modern times, is still going on and will continue. It requires an effort of detachment to recognize current change for what it is. We shall recognize that our behavior is simply that of one group at one point in time, and that in the next generation, the innovations that we deplore may well have become completely respectable and indeed uniquely right for the users. Moreover, why not enjoy the language that you speak; why not enjoy the richness and variety. In fact, the whole of nature is in flux, and so is the whole of human life and language.

Topic – 200: Factors that will determine the Future of English

Centrifugal vs. Centripetal Forces

However, history may no longer be a guide to what is happening to English today. In fact, the parallel with Latin is not perfect. One of the consequences of globalization is that through the media we have immediate access to other languages and two varieties of English other than our own, in ways that have come to be available but recently. And this is altering the manner in which people are aware of the language. Think of a group of people in an out-of-the-way village in Pakistan- clustering around a television -hearing BBC News. With a whole range of fresh auditory models becoming routinely available, it is easy to see how the type of English spoken in different countries could move in fresh directions. Global satellite communication has changed the whole scenario and is acting as the pull force imposed by the need for identity. Both centrifugal and centripetal forces operate in English. Alongside the need to reflect local situations and identities which foster diversity, there is the need for mutual comprehensibility which fosters standardization. People need to be able to understand each other, both within a country and internationally. There has always been a need for lingua francas; but now more than ever, we need a world language. And as supra-national organizations grow, the need becomes more pressing. The 191 members of the UN are there not simply to express their identities but also because they want to talk to each other. We know and understand that Standard English is not identical everywhere. Generally speaking, there are similarities in writing but dissimilarities in speaking. The history of Latin is no guide to the future of English. These centripetal forces that are at work today were lacking a thousand years ago. Once the Roman Empire had begun to fragment, there was nothing to stop the centrifugal forces tearing spoken Latin apart. In the Middle Ages, it was very easy for communities to be isolated from the rest of the world. Today, it is virtually impossible. Both centrifugal and centripetal forces exist in the modern world, and for that matter, we need both. We want to express our identity through language and we want to communicate intelligibly through language. We want to be different and we want to be the same.

BS English

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